Chapter 4

Our Senses and Our Eyes

We learn about the world around us through our senses. We have five senses, and each sense has its own sense organ.

- We see with our eyes.
- We hear with our ears.
- We smell with our nose.
- We taste with our tongue.
- We feel touch, heat and cold with our skin.

Our sense organs send messages to the brain through nerves. The brain understands these messages and tells us what we are seeing, hearing, smelling, tasting or touching.

Our eyes

Our eyes are very precious. Eyelids and eyelashes protect our eyes from dust. Tears keep our eyes wet and clean.

Look at a friend's eye carefully. The coloured part of the eye is called the iris. It may be brown, black, blue or green. The small black dot in the middle of the iris is called the pupil. Light goes into the eye through the pupil.

The pupil changes its size. In bright light, it becomes small to let in less light. In dim light, it becomes big to let in more light.

Activity

Close your eyes for one minute. Then open them and look at your eyes in a mirror at once. You will see your pupils become smaller as light enters.

Taking care of our eyes

- Read in good light. Reading in dim light strains the eyes.
- Keep your book about 30 centimetres away from your eyes.
- Do not rub your eyes. If dust gets in, wash them with clean water.
- Never look directly at the Sun. It can harm your eyes.
- Do not watch television or use a mobile phone for a long time. Rest your eyes by looking at something far away.
- Eat carrots, papaya, mangoes and green leafy vegetables. They are good for our eyes.

Some people cannot see clearly. They may wear spectacles to help them see better. If the board in your class looks blurred, tell your teacher or your parents.

Reading without seeing

People who cannot see can read with their fingers. They use Braille, a way of writing with raised dots on paper. Each letter has its own pattern of dots. Braille was invented by Louis Braille, a boy from France who could not see.

Let's think

1. Name the five sense organs.
2. What happens to the pupil in bright light?
3. Write three ways to take care of your eyes.

New words

pupil - the black dot in the middle of the eye that lets light in
Braille - writing with raised dots that can be read by touch